

Data Retention & Disposal Policy

Persistence

Owner: Founder (acting Security Lead) · **Contact:** support@persistence.finance

Version: 1.0 · **Effective:** 2026-06-16 · **Review cadence:** at least annually, and after any material change

1. Purpose & scope

This policy defines how long Persistence retains the data it handles and how that data is securely disposed of when it is no longer needed. It covers all personal and **consumer financial data** — including data obtained through Plaid — across the web app, desktop app, API, database, and backups. Its goals are to keep data only as long as there is a legitimate need and to dispose of it securely, in line with applicable data-privacy laws.

2. Roles & responsibilities

The **Founder, acting as Security Lead**, owns this policy and is accountable for enforcing retention limits, honoring user deletion/export requests, and reviewing the policy periodically.

3. Principles

- **Data minimization:** we collect and keep only what is necessary to provide the service.
- **Storage limitation:** data is retained no longer than needed for its purpose or as required by law.
- **Secure disposal:** when data is no longer needed, it is deleted or rendered unrecoverable.
- **User control:** users can export or permanently delete their data at any time.

4. Retention schedule

- **Account & identity data** (email, Google profile): retained for the life of the account; erased upon account deletion.
- **Plaid access tokens & linked-account data:** retained until the institution is unlinked or the account is deleted. Unlinking invalidates the token; account deletion revokes all bank connections at Plaid.
- **Financial data** (balances, transactions, net-worth snapshots, bills, goals): retained for the life of the account; erased upon account deletion.
- **Operational & diagnostic data** (request logs, error reports): retained for a limited, rolling period for security and reliability, then aged out.
- **Billing records** (e.g., subscription/customer identifiers, plan status): retained for the duration of the subscription and thereafter only as required for tax, accounting, and fraud-prevention obligations.
- **Backups:** rotated on a rolling schedule; deleted records age out as backups cycle and are not selectively restored.

5. User-initiated export & deletion

- **Export:** users can download a complete export of the data we hold from the app (Sidebar → Account → Export my data).
- **Unlink:** disconnecting an institution invalidates its Plaid access token.
- **Delete:** users can permanently delete their account in-app; this removes their personal and financial data from the primary database and revokes their bank connections at Plaid.
- Verified deletion or access requests submitted to support@persistence.finance are honored.

6. Secure disposal

When data is deleted, records are removed from the primary database. Sensitive secrets (notably Plaid access tokens) are stored encrypted with AES-256-GCM, so any residual ciphertext — for example in a backup that has not yet cycled out — is unreadable without the encryption key; rotating or destroying keys renders such residual data permanently unrecoverable. Backups containing deleted data expire on their rolling retention cycle.

7. Legal & regulatory compliance

Persistence retains and disposes of data in line with applicable data-privacy laws and honors users' rights to access, export, and delete their personal data. Where a specific category must be retained to meet a legal, tax, or fraud-prevention obligation, it is kept only for that purpose and for no longer than required. This policy is consistent with the public Privacy Policy at <https://persistence.finance/privacy.html>.

8. Third-party processors

Deletion propagates to processors where applicable — most importantly, bank connections are revoked at Plaid upon account deletion. Other subprocessors (e.g., payment, email, error-monitoring providers) retain limited operational records under their own retention policies and contractual terms.

9. Enforcement & review

Deletion and export are enforced technically through in-app controls and operationally by the Security Lead. This policy is reviewed at least annually and after any material change to systems, data flows, processors, or applicable law. It complements the Persistence Information Security Policy and Access Control Policy.